leaders from Delhi had been SRCC alumni, including Arun Jaitley, the leader of the Opposition in the Rajya Sabha and legal eagle. The topic —'Emerging Business Models in a Global Scenario'—was perfect as well. 'We were looking to launch Mr Modi in an environment which was not hostile and where he could speak to the young of India, not just as Gujarat chief minister but as a future CEO of India,' a key Modi aide told me.

The 'youth' factor was key. Team Modi had commissioned surveys which suggested that the mood for change was highest among the young, with the fear of lack of job opportunities in a weakening economy being a prime concern. There was a feeling that it was the young urban Indian whom the BJP had failed to attract in the 2009 elections, preferring as they did the youthful promise offered by a Rahul Gandhi to the tried and tested octogenarian L.K. Advani. 'We realized that the young voter, especially the first-time voter between eighteen and twenty-three, was waiting to be wooed. For that reason, SRCC as a college to which many young people aspired to gain admission was ideal for us,' said a Team Modi member.

Addressing a young, post-liberalization India had another advantage. The 3000-strong audience in the college's sports complex comprised mainly excited students who had not even entered their teens when the 2002 Gujarat riots took place. They were free, in a sense, of the images of the violence and criticism the Modi government had endured at the time. Six years earlier, Modi had come to Delhi for the *Hindustan Times* summit and found himself being asked uncomfortable questions on 2002. This time, he was taking no chances—it was a lecture where he could speak without having to take any questions. The media was present in large numbers, but this wasn't a press conference where they could try and corner the Gujarat chief minister. This time, they would simply have to listen, take notes and record the speech.

The event went off spectacularly well. Modi spoke for a little more than an hour, holding forth about governance, the economy and the Gujarat model of business. Speaking in Hindi without any notes or the slightest hesitation, Modi gave a masterful oration, peppered with one-liners: 'We have got swaraj, but after sixty years, we are still looking for *suraaj* (good